volume of crime) would be necessary in an effort to examine the contours of any possible relationship between the quality of crimes reported and lunar cycles. Only then could this question of the lunar lore and crime be more fully answered.

Notes

1. See Rotton and Cohn (2000) and Cohn (1990b), among others, for a discussion of theoretical and empirical relationships between weather, temporal variables, social contact variables, and crime.

2. Block (1984) wrote that although some general seasonal trends could be noted, they tended to be offense-specific and were not evident in all jurisdictions. Her comprehensive review of data she analyzed, as well as various published and unpublished research done by others, found ample variation in seasonal trends. Some of this might have been attributed to variable data, operational definitions, and analytical plans.

3. Researchers have employed myriad methods of structuring the timing and intensity of full moons relative to other periods of the lunar cycle. For example: contrasting the day of the full moon with all other days in the cycle (Frey et al., 1979); creating seemingly-capricious "windows" of time (i.e., three days) around the full moon for contrast with the rest of the cycle (sometimes separating out windows of time around the new moon) (Walters et al., 1975); breaking cycles into equal (Frey et al., 1979; Quinsey & Varney, 1977; Taylor & Diespecker, 1972) and unequal (Frey et al., 1979; Lester et al., 1969) periods of times; and, allowing lunar phase to vary from day to day throughout the lunar cycle (Simon, 1998). The lunar lore is ambiguous regarding whether the influence of the moon is truly restricted to full-moon periods and whether a heightened full moon influence might be offset by a converse effect during the new moon.

4. This consideration was another complexity created by the vague nature of the lunar lore. Was the effect of the full moon mediated by its visibility due to daylight and/or weather patterns? If the effect was thought to result from the actual intensity of the moon's illumination, the answer may have been "yes." If the effect was thought to result from the moons 'pull' on water in the human body, the answer might have been "no."

5. An anonymous reviewer pointed out the U.S.N.O. also reports moon rise and setting times within archival data. It was noted using a sliding window of analysis based on whether the moon was above the horizon might have been an alternative approach within the analysis. Additional analyses not reported here, but available from the lead author upon request, suggest the results were not substantively different with the use of such a variable window of analysis. The original models (fixed 8:00 pm –– 3:00 am window of analysis) were retained for the analysis reported in this article, though the alternative scheme was included in later portions of the discussion.

6. The analysis was also conducted using a measure of the moon's actual visibility above the horizon net of atmospheric conditions that might preclude such visibility. These models yielded no significant differences in parameter magnitudes or significance levels. Since the same pattern of significant and non-significant results was obtained, the initial results were retained and presented in this article. Those seeking further information pertaining to these alternative modeling efforts can direct inquires to the second author.

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